

Pillow Talk - *Why We're Betting on Boutique Hotels*

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Most real estate is pretty patient.

Sign a lease. Collect rent. Wait a year. Raise it, maybe.

Hotels play a different game. The inventory resets every night, and so does the opportunity.

You can change the rate. Change the experience. Add a restaurant. Host a wedding. Build a brand. Turn an empty lawn into goat yoga if that's your thing.

Same real estate. A lot more buttons to push.

More ways to screw it up? Absolutely.

But that's kind of why we're here.

We understand why some investors look at hotels and say, "Yeah...I'll stick with apartments."

We look at the same complexity and see something different:

Levers. Lots of them.

— FROM THE FRONT DESK

Take a 30-room hotel doing a \$250 ADR at 60% occupancy. That's roughly **\$1.64M in annual room revenue.**

Get those same 30 rooms to a \$275 ADR and 65% occupancy? **\$1.96M.**

That's roughly **\$320,000 in additional annual revenue without building another room.**

And that's before direct bookings, weddings, F&B, events, packages, or finally figuring out what to do with that giant lawn everyone keeps calling "potential."

A 30-unit apartment building has 30 apartments to monetize.

A 30-room hotel has 30 rooms **plus whatever else you can make people want to eat, drink, book, attend or post about.**

The real estate creates the foundation. The business creates the upside.

And yes, maybe I'm biased, but nobody has ever come back from vacation excited to tell me about the self-storage facility they saw..

— THE HOTEL ISN'T JUST THE HOTEL

Would you come here if you weren't sleeping here?

It's one of our favorite questions when looking at a hotel.

Dinner. Drinks. Weddings. Wellness. Live music. Handmade pappardelle straight from Uncle Tony & Carmela's recipe book. A pool cabana your favorite influencer can do a photoshoot at. A ridiculous sauna in the woods. Maybe a \$24 travel sized vodka bottle in the mini bar.

A wedding can sell rooms, food, drinks and the venue. A restaurant brings in people who don't need a room. An experience gives someone a reason to choose you over the 47 other tabs they have open.

— THE INVESTMENT CASE, WITHOUT THE 40-PAGE DECK

Real estate underneath it.

You own the dirt and building.

Pricing power every night.

No waiting for next year's lease renewal.

More than one way to make a dollar.

Rooms. F&B. Weddings. Events. Experiences.

And if somebody wants to pay \$42 for a robe with your logo on it, we'll sell em that too.

You can actually influence NOI.

Better operations, pricing, marketing and design can all move the number.

And NOI can create equity.

Improve the business and you can improve the value of the real estate underneath it.

Real estate + operating business + multiple revenue streams + controllable upside.

— YES, HOTELS ARE HARDER.

We know.

Employees. Guests. Housekeeping. Marketing. Daily pricing. Maintenance. F&B. And unlike your apartment tenant, a hotel guest can tell 10,000 strangers about the AC never actually going down despite how low you set it.

That's exactly why a lot of investors stay away.

You generally can't improve an apartment's Google ranking, change tomorrow night's rent, launch a wedding business, redesign the lobby and teach the leasing office how to make a proper Old Fashioned.

The catch is that somebody actually has to know what they're doing.

Of course, "lots of levers" sounds great until you realize somebody has to know how to pull all of them.

That's a mildly inconvenient number of specialties.

Behind it is a team that has owned more than 70 hotels and spent careers investing in, operating, developing, marketing, designing and repositioning hospitality businesses.

More importantly, we've seen what doesn't. Some of those lessons were considerably more expensive.

ROAM HOSPITALITY • HOTEL TURNKEY

The team behind ROAM has owned, operated, and scaled hospitality.

ROAM Hospitality is an operator-led boutique hotel management company. Our leadership has built national hotel platforms, scaled multi-market hospitality portfolios, and run day-to-day operations across dozens of markets. When we take on a hotel — or a Hotel Turnkey engagement — the people executing have already done it at scale.

70+

Hotels owned & operated across the team

750+

Short-term rentals launched & scaled

\$1.2B+

Commercial real estate invested & managed

Multi-market

Boutique hotels & assets across U.S. markets

PARTNERS & LEADERSHIP

Punit Shah PARTNER
CEO of Liberty Group, a family office that has invested more than **\$1.2B in commercial real estate**. Before transitioning to a family office, Punit built and operated a **national hospitality platform of 57 hotels and 5,000+ rooms** across Hilton, Marriott, and IHG. Partner and co-owner of the Miami Martinis, member of the IHG Owners Association Global Board and YPO. Bilings scale, capital, and institutional-grade operating experience to ROAM.

Michael Sjogren PARTNER
Investor, entrepreneur, CPA, and operator. Founder & CEO of Short Term Rental Secrets, host of the STR Secrets podcast, and co-founder of the STR Wealth Conference. His own portfolio includes **50+ short-term rentals across four states and three boutique hotels on Boston's North Shore** — hands-on proof of the underwriting, launch, and scaling playbook he brings to ROAM.

Elliott Caldwell CO-FOUNDER & CEO
Leads ROAM Hospitality and is a founding partner of Rise Collective, the parent platform spanning hospitality, real estate, and investment. Elliott built ROAM to help **independent hotels maximize revenue while keeping the character that sets them apart** — pairing data-informed strategy with disciplined operations. His focus: high-performing teams, efficient properties, and owner outcomes.

Michael Elfante PRESIDENT & CO-FOUNDER
Founding partner of ROAM and Rise Collective, focused on investment strategy and the expansion of hospitality-driven real estate. Known for **building and scaling a multi-million-dollar portfolio**, Michael guides owners and investors as they move from single-property short-term rentals into boutique hotel and performance-oriented hospitality assets.

Kyle Murphy CHIEF OPERATIONS OFFICER
COO of Rise Collective and ROAM Hospitality, overseeing operations, systems, and guest experience across the portfolio. With a background in **large-scale vacation rental and multi-unit operations**, Kyle brings a systems-driven approach to running high-performing properties — the operational backbone that makes consistent execution repeatable across markets.

Jacob Odell SENIOR DIRECTOR OF OPERATIONS
Hospitality and operations leader with **15+ years driving performance across hotels, flexible accommodations, coworking, and mixed-use real estate**. At ROAM, Jacob has led multi-unit operations with full P&L accountability — revenue strategy, budgeting, brand development, and renovations — bringing structure to complex environments and building high-performing teams that deliver consistent results.

Wade Langville IV DIRECTOR OF DEVELOPMENT
Leads planning and execution of development across ROAM's boutique hotel and hospitality assets — **identifying opportunities, managing the project pipeline, and overseeing the transformation of properties into high-performing destinations**. Works across design, operations, and brand on each project with goals aligned with market demand and long-term asset performance.

Every engagement is run by people who have carried the operational and financial risk themselves — owners and operators, not consultants.

— WADE'S TAKE

If I'm spending \$300-400 a night, give me something I don't have at home.

Give me the outdoor shower. Have the bartender call me Mr. Wade - a little respect around here for once eh? Shape my towel like a zoo animal.

People comparison-shop commodities. They seek out experiences.

If your room looks like every other room on Expedia, eventually you're competing on price.

If people specifically want to stay at your hotel, you're playing a different game.

And that's especially powerful in boutique hospitality, where you don't need to fill 400 rooms every night.

You need 20, 30 or 40 rooms worth of people who really want to be there.

— LAST KEY

Hotels aren't attractive because they're easy.

If easy were the goal, we'd probably own a Taco Bell.

We like them because they're complex—and complexity creates opportunity for people who know what they're doing.

Plus, Taco Bell won't let us grow our own lettuce in the garden outside... though maybe they should.

Like it or not, I'll see you next month.

[Discuss Hotel Acquisitions or Operations](#) →

Or just reply, I read every response.

Until next time, Wade

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